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Deutsche Bank Research

Rating
Buy

North America
United States

Consumer
Autos & Auto Technology

Company
Tesla Inc.

Reuters	Bloomberg	Exchange	Ticker
TSLA.OQ	TSLA US	NMS	TSLA

Date
30 January 2026

Company Update

Price at 29 Jan 2026 (USD)	416.56
Price target	480.00
52-week range	489.88 - 221.86

All in on Physical AI

Valuation & Risks

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If there were any doubts about Tesla fully committing to robotaxi and humanoids, these are entirely gone following 4Q25 earnings. With capex now expected to more than double this year and even ambitions to possibly stand up a chip fab, management is clearly looking beyond the traditional auto market and aiming to structurally disrupt labor intensive services with a vertically integrated Physical AI stack. Our valuation has been underpinned by success in Physical AI since we resumed coverage. As such, our core framework remains mostly the same, with a few adjustments; reiterate Buy while trimming price target by $20 to $480.

What does $20bn buy?

For the +$20bn capex outlook, we attempt to break it down by category with the largest spending likely being on training compute.

- **Compute/AI - $7-9bn (35%-45%)**: Tesla's historical spend on AI/compute was ~$5bn annually. With the Cortex 2 expansion at Giga Texas, this would require 100-150k H100 GPU equivalents with associated infrastructure.
  - Per GPU cost is roughly ~$25k for H100 and at 100-150k H100s, this would total $2.5-$3.75bn
  - Assume infrastructure cost is $15-20m per MW for optimized AI data centers and need 200 MW (larger than Cortex 1's initial ~130 MW), suggesting $3-4bn
  - We estimate another $1.25bn for further chip development, software, and other
- **Optimus - $3-4bn (15-20%)**: Includes re-purposing the Fremont site to accommodate Optimus production. We don't expect capacity to ramp to 1m units per year any time soon but the initial spending would include machinery, tooling, and testing facilities. There will also be a learning curve associated with this build out that we think likely leads to some overspend (e.g., to help shore up supply chain).
- **Vehicle production - $4-5bn (20-25%)**: ramping up Cybercab and also to lesser extent Semi.
- **Energy and batteries - $3-4bn (15-20%)**: Building another Megapack factory in Texas (in addition to the existing ones in California, Nevada and Shanghai), as well as continuing to ramp up LFP factory in Nevada, lithium refinery and cathode materials production in Texas.

Key changes

TP	500.00 to 480.00	↓	-4.0%
EPS (USD)	1.49 to 1.21	↓	-18.6%
Revenue (USDm)	97,673.7 to 94,520.3	↓	-3.2%

Source: Deutsche Bank

Distributed on: 30/01/2026 08:03:08 GMT

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Commercializing vehicle autonomy in focus

Tesla started to disclose active FSD subscriptions, exiting 4Q at 1.1m users (+38% YoY) globally with 70% being upfront purchases. Starting Feb 15, there will no longer be an option to pay upfront (i.e., only subscription based at $99/month). This may put some pressure on margins near-term given upfront purchases are highly accretive, but over time should level out. Looking ahead, we estimate FSD subscriptions could grow to $8-10bn in revenue by the early 2030s including some contribution from licensing to other automakers.

On Robotaxi, Tesla currently has >500 vehicles in the fleet between Austin and Bay Area. Management plans to launch in 7 more cities in 1H26 including Dallas, Houston, Phoenix, Miami, Orlando, Tampa Bay, and Las Vegas. In terms of fleet size, the goal seems to be doubling MoM going forward at some point. We estimate that by 2030E, the company can deploy nearly 500k vehicles in the Robotaxi network, including 100k coming from owners putting their own vehicles up, generating over $15bn in revenue, predicated on charging $0.85/mile and 30% commission. For Cybercab, we count external deliveries as Auto sales with any captive or supplemental revenue as Service/other.

Optimus – near term goals, challenges, and aspirations

Tesla affirmed its Gen-3 Optimus is set to be unveiled in a few months, promising to deliver much better performance (i.e., hand dexterity) and be easier to train/teach (learn from watching videos). Management is targeting 1m capacity but indicated there won't be meaningful volume until year-end. We anticipate just a couple of thousand units being made this year. The three main challenges are:

- **Hand**: Musk once again emphasized that the human hand is one of the most complex mechanical structures in existence. To replicate its dexterity, Tesla has had to design every actuator, gear, and sensor from scratch. As such, "perfecting" the Gen-3 hand has been the biggest engineering bottleneck, as it required fitting high-torque motors into the tiny area of the forearm and palm without sacrificing performance.
- **Brain**: Beyond the physical hardware, Musk stated that scaling is only useful if the "brain" can handle a diverse range of tasks. He highlighted the difficulty of moving from scripted lab moves to Vision-based autonomy, where the robot must "understand" and navigate changing factory floors at Giga Texas without human intervention. Critical to making this happen is enabling the humanoid to more easily learn/train based on video footage, which we believe is happening and why more compute is needed.
- **Scaling**: Musk commented the speed of the production ramp is inversely proportionate to how many new parts there are. Since Optimus shares almost no parts with a car, Tesla is building an entirely new supply chain for thousands of custom components. To solve this, Tesla is repurposing the Fremont factory's Model S and X lines (which will retire in 2Q26) to become the first high-volume "Optimus Factory."

Onshoring/insourcing chips and solar?

While the capex is expected to increase massively for 2026, this does not include any spend on chip fab or solar-cell production in the US. Management believes current suppliers may not be able to ramp up capacity fast enough (alluding to Samsung/TSMC on logic; Micron on memory) and beyond that, called out geopolitical risk as a reason to accelerate onshoring chip production. For Tesla to get involved here, the cost would naturally be very high. For example, the Samsung Taylor plant in Texas was initially announced with a $17bn investment commitment

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in 2021 which has reportedly increased to as high as $50bn. Separately, Tesla does not currently produce solar cells in the US, instead importing from overseas and then assembling them into solar panels. With demand potentially increasing in the future for non-residential use cases, Musk earlier this month alluded to Tesla working to build 100 GW of capacity in 3 years.

Figure 1: Estimate changes

	Prior				Revised			
	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2024	2025	2026E	2027E
Deliveries	**1,789,226**	**1,636,129**	**1,639,243**	**2,061,386**	**1,789,226**	**1,636,129**	**1,580,147**	**1,636,769**
Revenue ($m)	**97,690**	**94,316**	**97,674**	**119,519**	**97,690**	**94,827**	**94,520**	**103,321**
Automotive	77,070	69,106	66,088	79,755	77,070	69,526	64,370	64,896
Energy/storage	10,086	12,633	17,751	24,546	10,086	12,771	16,277	22,362
Services & other	10,534	12,577	13,834	15,218	10,534	12,530	13,873	16,064
Auto GM (GAAP)	18.4%	16.6%	14.4%	13.3%	18.4%	17.8%	15.6%	14.9%
Auto GM (ex-credit)	**15.4%**	**14.5%**	**13.3%**	**12.8%**	**15.4%**	**15.4%**	**14.0%**	**13.8%**
EPS (non-GAAP)	**$2.41**	**$1.53**	**$1.49**	**$2.00**	**$2.41**	**$1.66**	**$1.21**	**$1.49**
Free cash flow	**3,578**	**6,143**	**2,099**	**2,200**	**3,578**	**6,220**	**(6,014)**	**(1,719)**

Source : Company Reports, Deutsche Bank Research

Trim price target but reiterate Buy

Our valuation has been underpinned by future success in Physical AI since we resumed coverage. As such, our core framework remains mostly the same with two adjustments. First, we lower our vehicle deliveries estimates going forward, factoring in no new cheaper "regular" EV models being launched (~2.2m in 2030E). Second, we now split out FSD and Robotaxi in our SOTP (vs. prior combining them), using same multiple as before but applying 2030E time frame for FSD and 2035E for Robotaxi. Put together, this takes our price target down by $20 to $480.

Figure 2: SOTP valuation framework

	Revenue ($bn)	EBITDA	Multiple (x)	Enterprise value	Present value	Per share	Assumptions
Auto (2030E)	$75		6.0	452	312	$90	~2.2m unit sales
Energy (2030E)	$39	$12	15.0	176	122	$35	170 GWh storage deployed
FSD (2030E)	$10		30.0	300	207	$60	subscription + licensing
Humanoid robot (2035E)	$31		31.5	984	429	$124	1.25m robots @ $25k per unit
Robotaxi (2035E)	$45		30.0	1,350	588	$170	~2.0m vehicle fleet
Services/other (2030E)	$19		0.5	10	7	$2	accessories, F&I, used car sales
Total					**1,665**	**$480**	
Net debt					(36)		
Share count					3,539		
Discount rate					10%		

Source : Company Reports, Deutsche Bank Research

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Valuation & Risks

Our price target is based on a multi-modal SOTP looking at five businesses (discounted back): Auto, Energy storage, FSD, Optimus (humanoid), and Robotaxi. Automotive: we embed ~2.2m vehicle deliveries by 2030E and use a leading consumer electronic company's 6x EV/Revenue multiple as a reference due to similar brand appeal and reach. Energy storage: 170GWh at $220/kWh by 2030E; we use a peer multiple of 15x EV/EBITDA as a reference given a similar product offering and growth profile. Humanoid robot (Optimus): we assume 1.25m units at $25k/robot in 2035E; we use E2E AI peer multiples as a reference point. FSD and Robotaxi: we assume about $10bn in subscription sales+licensing by 2030E then a ~2m Robotaxi fleet in 2035E; we use E2E AI peer multiples as reference point.

Tesla faces a variety of risks given its broad reach. On automotive, we believe the largest risk is demand softness/stagnation related to EV fatigue and/or competition. For energy storage, the main end-market is B2B and competition is generally less intense than auto for now. For mobility and robotics, there is execution risk given a lot of data still needs to be collected and investment is required (e.g., chips) to achieve widespread commercialization. Moreover, there is regulatory risk as the governing bodies may choose to scrutinize real-world deployments of end-to-end AI. Unique to Tesla, we would also identify leadership risk considering Elon Musk's importance to the valuation of the company.

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Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

*Other information available upon request

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Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
Tesla Inc.	TSLA.OQ	416.56 (USD) 29 Jan 2026	8, 14, 15, 21, 24

*Prices are current as of the end of the previous trading session unless otherwise indicated and are sourced from local exchanges via Reuters, Bloomberg and other vendors . Other information is sourced from Deutsche Bank, subject companies, and other sources. For disclosures pertaining to recommendations or estimates made on securities other than the primary subject of this research, please see the most recently published company report or visit our global disclosure look-up page on our website at https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/EquityResearchDisclosures. Aside from within this report, important risk and conflict disclosures can also be found at https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/Disclaimer. Investors are strongly encouraged to review this information before investing.

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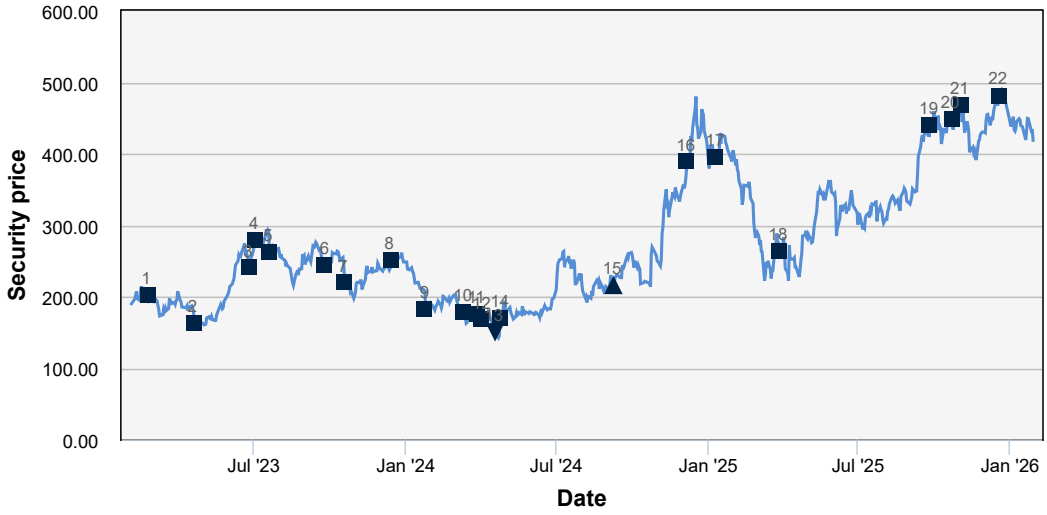
Historical recommendations and target price: Tesla Inc. (TSLA.OQ)

(as of 01/29/2026)



Current Recommendations
- Buy
- Hold
- Sell
- Not Rated
- Suspended Rating

** Analyst is no longer at Deutsche Bank

1.	02/23/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 250.00, Current Price USD 202.07 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
2.	04/20/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 200.00, Current Price USD 162.99 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
3.	06/26/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 260.00, Current Price USD 241.05 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
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5.	07/20/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 300.00, Current Price USD 262.90 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
6.	09/26/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 285.00, Current Price USD 244.12 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
7.	10/19/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 275.00, Current Price USD 220.11 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
8.	12/14/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 260.00, Current Price USD 251.05 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
9.	01/25/2024	Buy, Target Price Change USD 250.00, Current Price USD 182.63 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
10.	03/11/2024	Buy, Target Price Change USD 218.00, Current Price USD 177.77 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
11.	03/28/2024	Buy, Target Price Change USD 200.00, Current Price USD 175.79 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
12.	04/03/2024	Buy, Target Price Change USD 189.00, Current Price USD 168.38 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
13.	04/18/2024	Downgraded to Hold, Target Price Change USD 123.00, Current Price USD 149.93 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
14.	04/25/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 136.00, Current Price USD 170.18 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**
15.	09/09/2024	Upgraded to Buy, Target Price Change USD 295.00, Current Price USD 216.27 Edison Yu
16.	12/06/2024	Buy, Target Price Change USD 370.00, Current Price USD 389.22 Edison Yu
17.	01/10/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 420.00, Current Price USD 394.74 Edison Yu
18.	03/28/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 345.00, Current Price USD 263.55 Edison Yu
19.	09/26/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 435.00, Current Price USD 440.40 Edison Yu
20.	10/23/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 440.00, Current Price USD 448.98 Edison Yu
21.	11/03/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 470.00, Current Price USD 468.37 Edison Yu
22.	12/19/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 500.00, Current Price USD 481.20 Edison Yu

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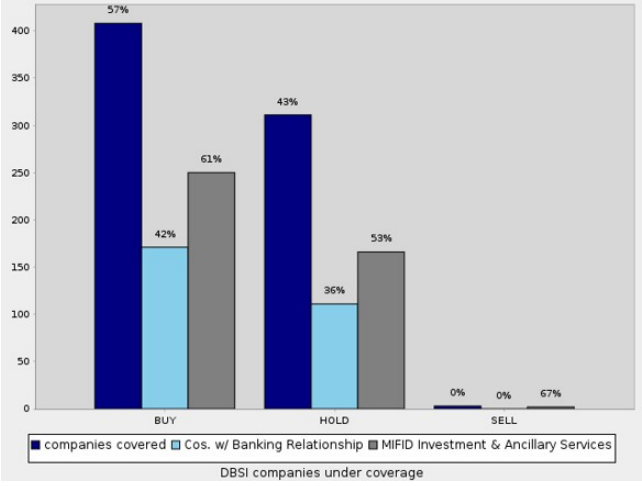
Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



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The Equity Rating Dispersion Chart depicts the following:

The proportion of recommendations that are rated "buy", "sell" and "hold" over the previous 12 months. This is shown for securities issued in the stated region e.g. "Europe Universe". See rating definitions below. This is represented by the "Companies Covered" bars in the chart. The percentage value displayed above the bar is the proportion as a percentage. E.g. 50% above the “buy” / “Companies Covered” bar means that 50% of DB’s equity research covered companies over the past 12 months have a “buy” rating.

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